

1) Product & loan rules (the real “business logic”)

Get their exact definitions (don't assume).

- **Loan products list:** product names, target client types (salary, group, SME, emergency, etc.)
- **Principal range:** min/max per product
- **Tenure options:** days/weeks/months, allowed terms
- **Interest model:** flat vs reducing balance vs daily interest; interest rate per product
- **Fees:** application, processing, insurance, ledger fees, SMS fees, etc. (fixed vs %)
- **Penalty rules:** when penalty starts, rate, compounding or not, grace period
- **Repayment schedules:** weekly/monthly/custom; holidays/weekends handling
- **Top-up/refinance** rules: allowed? how to treat old balance and fees
- **Early settlement rules:** rebate? how to compute remaining interest/fees
- **Write-off rules:** who approves, when, accounting impact
- **Collateral / guarantor rules:** required fields, valuation, enforcement notes
- **Approval workflow:** levels/roles, required documents, committee steps
- **Credit policy:** max exposure per client, multiple concurrent loans allowed? limits

Their current loan policy document + sample loan files (5–10 real cases, anonymized if needed).

2) Customer & KYC requirements

- Customer types: individual / business / group
- Required KYC fields: NIN, passport, LC letter, photo, address, next of kin, employer, etc.

- Document types and file size limits
- Group lending: group structure, leaders, joint liability rules
- Customer status lifecycle: prospect → active → dormant → blacklisted, etc.

4) Accounting / chart of accounts (If they already run accounting (even Excel), get:

- Chart of Accounts (COA) or at least account mapping:
 - loan principal receivable
 - interest income
 - penalty income
 - fees income
 - mobile money charges/commissions
 - write-offs / provisions
- Reporting periods: monthly/quarterly
- How they recognize revenue (especially interest)

If they *don't* have formal accounting in the old system, still ask what reports they submit to management/regulators.

5) Roles, permissions, branches, and controls

- Org structure: branches, teams, regions
- Roles: admin, teller/cashier, loan officer, credit manager, accountant, auditor, supervisor
- Approval limits by role (e.g., officer up to 2M UGX, manager above)
- Audit requirements:

- activity logs needed?
 - edits allowed on posted transactions? (ideally: reversals only)
- Maker-checker rules for disbursements and adjustments

6) Data migration (from old system / Excel)

- Current data source: old software DB? Excel? paper?
- What you're migrating:
 - customers
 - active loans
 - repayment history
 - savings (if any)
 - guarantors/collateral
- Data quality issues to expect (duplicates, missing phone numbers)
- Cutover plan: "go live" date, and whether you run parallel for 1–2 weeks

Deliverable: **exports** + a **data dictionary** if they have one (or you create it from their exports).

7) Reports & dashboards they expect

Ask for **their exact report templates** (PDF/Excel screenshots are fine).

Common ones:

- Portfolio at Risk (PAR 1/7/30/90)
- arrears list
- daily collections report

- disbursements report
- interest/fee income report
- staff performance (collections per officer)
- client statements
- audit trail / transaction log
- mobile money reconciliation report

8) Notifications & customer communications

- SMS/WhatsApp notifications: repayment reminder, overdue reminder, disbursement confirmation, receipt
- Message templates + language(s)
- Sender IDs / approved SMS provider (if they already have one)
- Consent requirements (especially if they're strict)

10) Security, compliance, and legal

- Required login policies: MFA? password rules?
- Data retention: how long to keep logs and customer data
- Regulatory requirements (BoU / internal audit)
- NDAs, access rules to production data
- Who can export data? (big risk in microfinance)

11) Mobile money agent integration details (your HTTP posting)

This is what will make or break “automatic reflection”.

You need from them:

- Which SIM/device(s) will receive notifications (dedicated phone recommended)
- The **exact notification sources**:
 - SMS?
 - push notifications from MoMo/Airtel apps?
- Confirmation whether they can get:
 - official API access (best, if possible), OR
 - merchant portal exports, OR
 - you must rely on phone notifications (works, but handle edge cases)
- Transaction fields you must capture:
 - transaction ID
 - amount
 - sender number/name (if available)
 - time
 - balance (if included)
 - fee (if included)
- Failure handling:
 - offline mode (queue & retry)
 - duplicate detection (idempotency using transaction ID)
 - manual override tools for exceptions

12) Acceptance criteria + rollout plan

Get agreement on:

- What “done” means (example: “95% of transactions auto-match within 60 seconds”)
- User training plan (who gets trained, how many sessions)
- Pilot branch first, then all branches
- Support process after go-live (how they report issues, SLA)